TK-8 Mandarin Immersion School Site Working Group

Meeting #1
October 29, 2026



Today's Agenda

- Welcome and Introductions
- Public Comment
- Working Group Charter
- Background and Criteria
- Closing

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Interpretation

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Interpretation

For interpretation, please call:

Mandarin:
1 413-685-2784 PIN: 839 912 200#

Cantonese:
1 650-542-9661 PIN: 282 002 096#

Spanish:
1 513-909-4645 PIN: 809 442 230#

Welcome and Introductions

Working Group Members

1. **Paula Antram**
   Principal, Jose Ortega Elementary School
2. **Serena Chan,**
   Counselor, San Francisco International High School
3. **Abby Chao,**
   Prospective SFUSD parent and co-founder of Friends of the SF Mandarin School
4. **Jose Gomez-Melendez,**
   Program Administrator, SFUSD Multilingual Pathways Department
5. **Frank Lara**
   Current SFUSD parent and Executive Vice President, United Educators of San Francisco (UESF)
6. **Liana Szeto**
   Founding Principal, Alice Fong Yu Alternative School
7. **Gabi G. Wu,**
   Current SFUSD parent and President of Wah Mei Board of Directors

Public Comment

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Working Group Charter

Purpose (why are we meeting?)

To **recommend a permanent location** for the TK-8 Mandarin Immersion School to the Superintendent by January 2027, **through a public, deliberative process.**

Scope (what are the boundaries of this work?)

The working group will:

- Review data, such as enrollment trends and facilities capacity
- Identify academic, community, and instructional needs for the site
- Propose decision criteria
- Develop a recommendation for a permanent location

The working group will **not** weigh in on hiring decisions, including the founding principal and teachers.

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Group Agreements (how we will work together)

Keep students at the center

Weigh options by what best serves current and future SFUSD students and families, including their academic, instructional, and community needs.

Treat each other with respect

Seek to understand other perspectives before responding, assume good intent, and critique ideas rather than people. Members bring different expertise, and all of it informs the recommendation.

Show up and stay engaged

Attend all four meetings and participate actively. If you must miss one, tell the facilitation team in advance and review the materials and notes afterward. With so few meetings, every voice matters.

Reaching Consensus (How we'll decide)

Our goal is to reach consensus on a site recommendation.

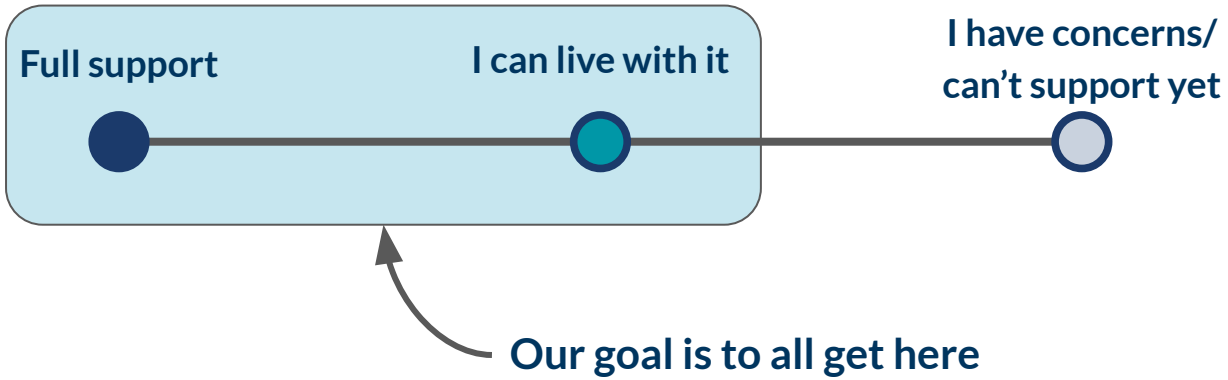
- Every member can support the recommendation, *even if it isn't their first choice.*

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Reaching Consensus (How we'll decide)

Testing for consensus

- More than a binary yes/no. Members can register support *and* reservations using **gradients of agreement**

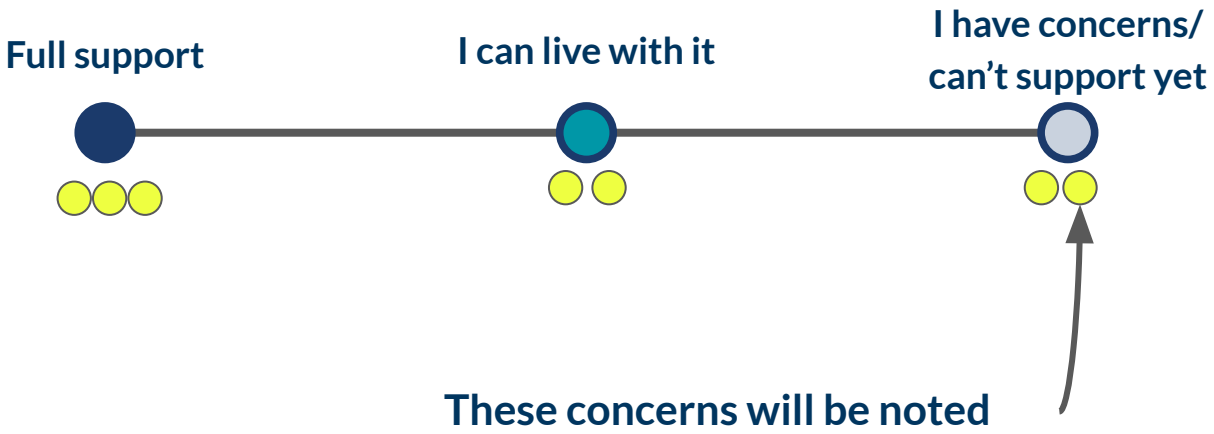


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Reaching Consensus (How we'll decide)

If we can't reach consensus

- We will put forward the recommendation with the most support and note any concerns or reservations



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Reaching Consensus (How we'll decide)

How we get there

- **October-November:** Identify site needs, agree on evaluation criteria, review data and shortlist of candidate sites
- **December**: Review candidate sites and develop draft recommendation for discussion
- **January**: Finalize and issue the recommendation

Meeting Scope and Sequence

Key decisions ahead

TODAY

Kickoff
Group norms, fact base, evaluation criteria

Nov 12

Review candidate sites
Initial site analysis and discussion

Dec 10

Preliminary recommendation
Refined site analysis and preliminary recommendation

Jan 7

Recommendation
Final site analysis and recommendation to the Superintendent

Discussion

What questions do you have about our charter as a working group?

Are there other group agreements we should add?

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Background and Criteria

Mandarin Dual Language Immersion

Program	Overview	Instruction	*Students Served
Elementary Two-Way **Immersion [DLI]**	Develop bilingualism and biliteracy in both English and the program language.	Students receive instruction in both the program language and English, developing academic content knowledge and language proficiency in both languages.	• Bilingual and native speakers of the program language • English-only speakers • Speakers of all other languages

Facilities Considerations

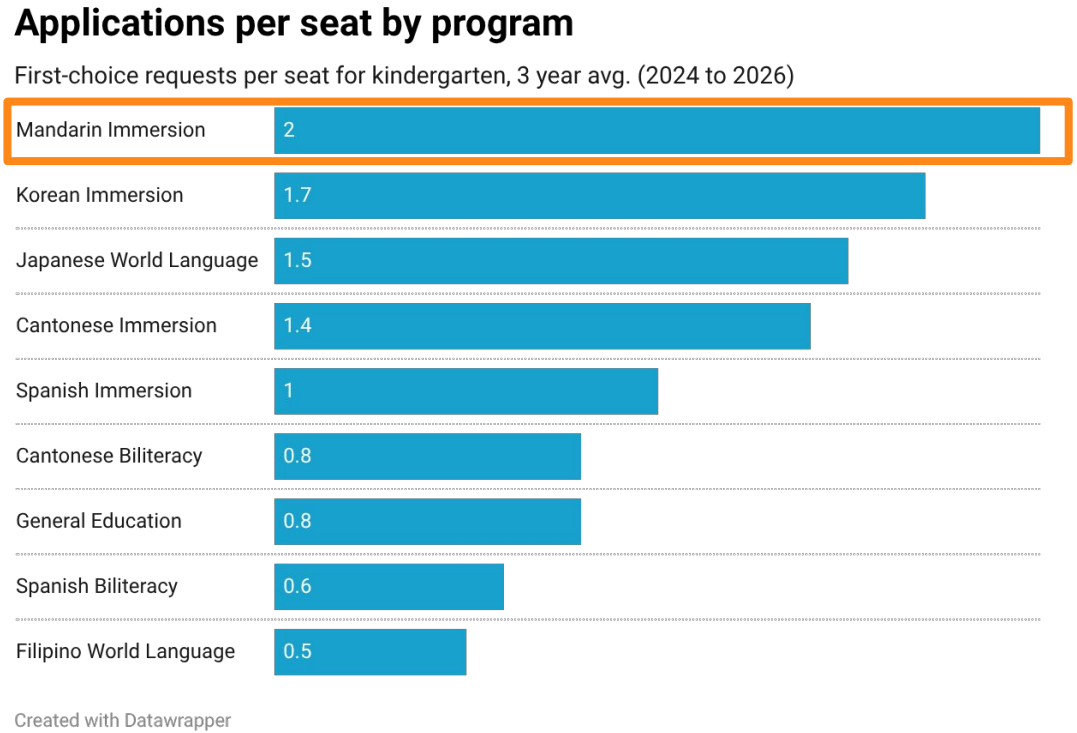
Temporary Site: Mission Education Center (1670 Noe St.)

- Open 1 TK and 3 Kindergarten classes in Fall 2027

Permanent Site

- In 2028 move to a permanent location with capacity for a full program of 2 TK classes, 3 classes K-3rd, 2 classes 4th-8th
  - Minimum **24 classrooms** needed including 5 TK/K compliant classrooms
  - Maximum **30 classrooms**
- Avoid sites that require major capital projects (cost and timeline)
- Consider yard/outdoor space for ~600 TK-8 students

Mandarin Immersion Is In High Demand



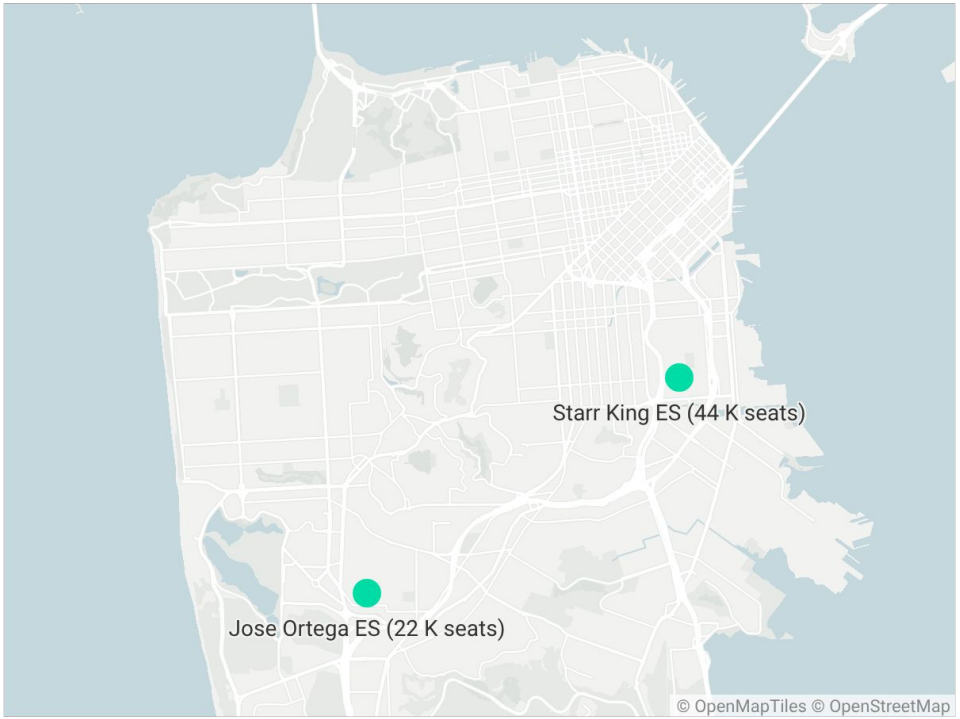
- In Kindergarten, the Mandarin Immersion program has been the **most popular program** on a per-seat basis over the last three years.
- For every seat available, there are two applicants who list the Mandarin program as their top choice.

Source: Main Round application data from 2024-25, 2025-26, and 2026-27

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Mandarin Immersion Capacity is Limited

Elementary School Mandarin Immersion Programs



SAN FRANCISCO UNIFIED SCHOOL DISTRICT
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- **66 Kindergarten seats** across **two schools**:
  - Starr King Elementary (44)
  - Jose Ortega Elementary (22)
- Programs feed into Aptos Middle School

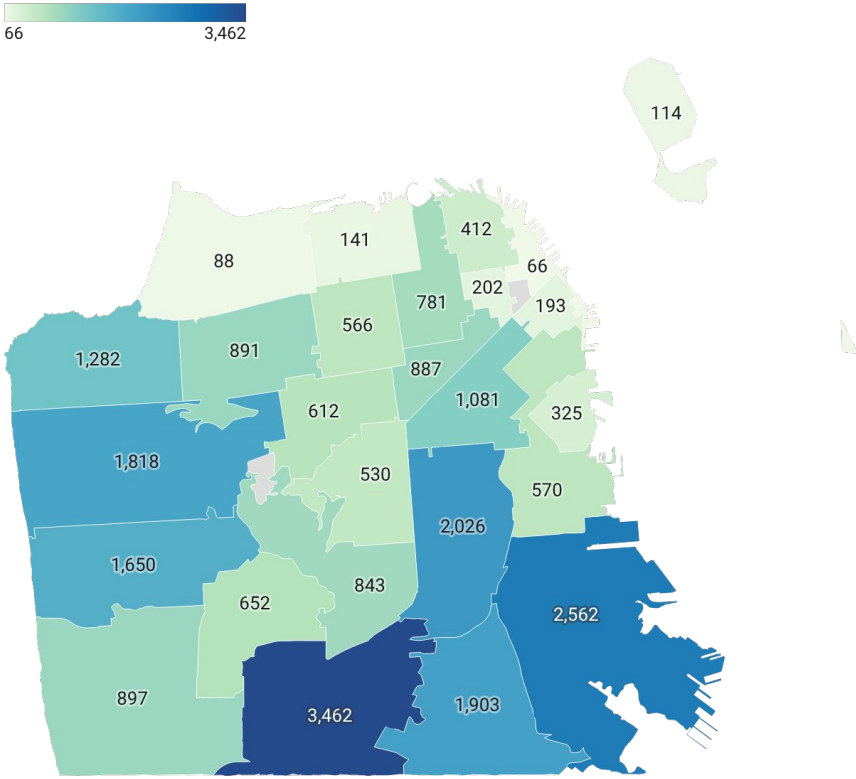
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Where TK-5 SFUSD Students Live

- With few Mandarin programs, we may want to prioritize sites that are accessible to many families
- Most students live in the **southeast, central,** or **western** part of San Francisco
  - 94112 (Excelsior/OMI)
  - 94124 (Bayview)
  - 94110 (Mission/Bernal)
  - 94134 (Vis Valley/Portola)
  - 94122 (Sunset)

TK-5 SFUSD Students by Home ZIP

Most SFUSD students live in the Southeast or Western part of the City



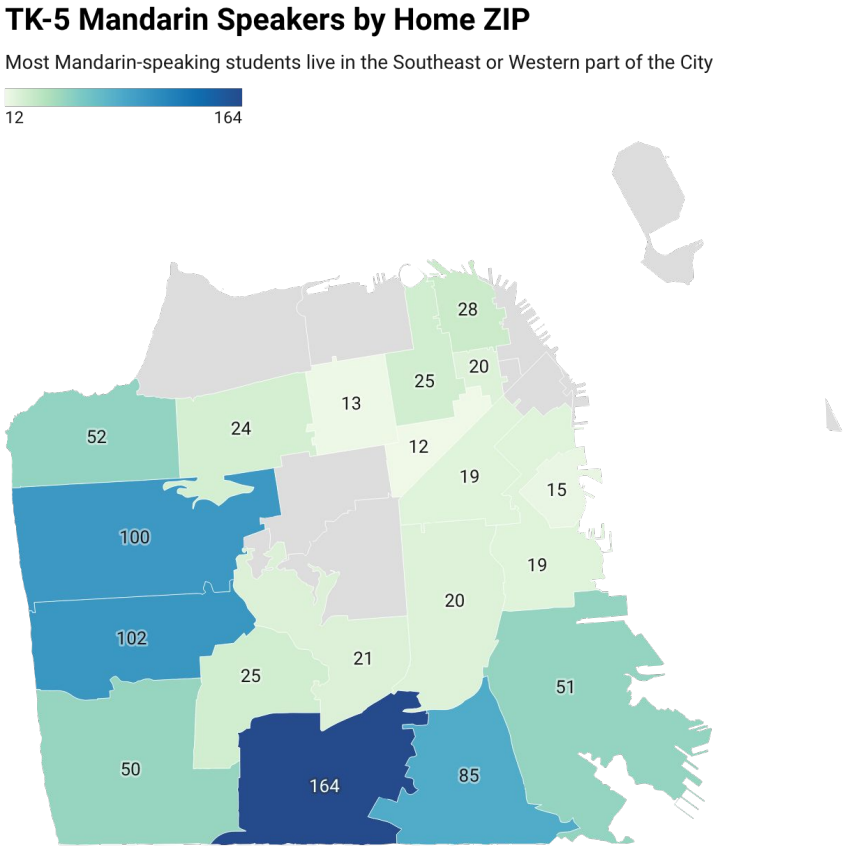
Preliminary 2026-27 CBEDS data. Count of TK-5 students. ZIP Codes with ten or fewer students not reported.

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Where Mandarin-speaking Students Live

- Dual Language Immersion programs reserve some seats for students who already speak the target language
- Most Mandarin-speaking students live in the **southeast** or **western** part of San Francisco
  - 94112 (Excelsior/OMI)
  - 94122 (Sunset)
  - 94116 (Sunset)
  - 94134 (Vis Valley/Portola)
  - 94121 (Outer Richmond)



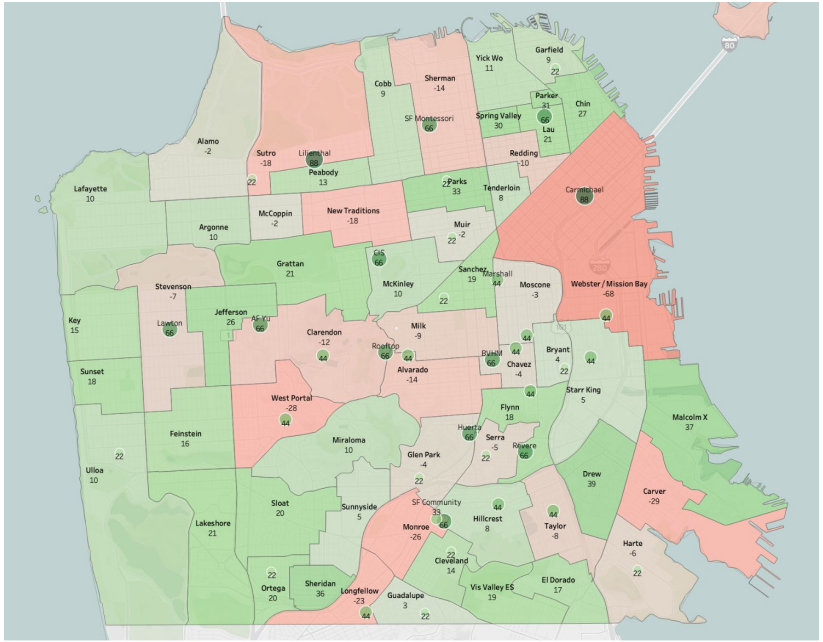
Preliminary 2026-27 CBEDS data. Count of TK-5 students whose home language is Mandarin. ZIP Codes with ten or fewer Mandarin-speaking students not reported.

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New Neighborhood Schools Assignment Policy

- The new site must be compatible with the shift toward **neighborhood schools**
  - Oct. 13 Board vote to move toward neighborhood assignments for elementary school
  - Language programs will remain citywide choices
- Some neighborhoods lack enough General Education seats for the students who live there
- TK-8 Mandarin Immersion can't displace seats in shortage areas



- **Students:** all K applicants + enrollees, GE only (2033 projection)
- **Seats:** full building use, local GE program seats only; citywide schools separate

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Possible Additional Considerations

When evaluating candidate sites for the permanent location, this group may consider:

- Do surrounding schools have sufficient capacity to accommodate displaced students?
- Would special education programming be displaced?
- Would an existing language pathway be displaced?
- Where do families live and how far are families willing to travel for a program?
- How is the neighborhood's population forecasted to change over time?

Discussion Questions

Next meeting, we will bring a shortlist of candidate sites for your review.

- What additional information would you like to see to support decision-making?
- What criteria should this group use to develop its recommendation?

Closing